

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Mediterranean Chicken Pasta Salad

with Feta, Peppers, and Oregano Vinaigrette

Tonight's easy yet impressive pasta salad is perfect for a summer picnic or potluck. We toss al dente penne noodles in a dressing of earthy dried oregano, tangy red wine vinegar, a hint of sugar, and olive oil. We also add plenty of mix-ins: sweet mini peppers, seasonal cherry tomatoes, Niçoise olives, feta, and cucumber. Slices of pan-roasted chicken and a garnish of more feta complete each plate.

20–30 minutes 1100 calories per serving

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MEALS WORTH MAKING

Ingredients

- 2 boneless skin-on chicken breasts
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 8 ounces penne pasta
- ½ pint multicolor cherry tomatoes
- 2 mini sweet peppers
- 1 Persian cucumber
- 2 tablespoons Niçoise olives
- 2 tablespoons red wine vinegar
- ¼ teaspoon sugar
- 2 ounces crumbled feta cheese

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
8" medium pot with lid
10" medium pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Feel free to slice the cucumber as usual—we like to cut it on a diagonal, also known as the bias cut, for a cheffy touch and elegant presentation.

If you're planning on bringing this to a potluck or picnic, in a large serving bowl, stir together pasta salad and sliced chicken. Cover bowl with plastic wrap and chill in refrigerator for up to 1 day. When you're ready to serve, garnish with remaining feta.

The chicken might have a slight odor as a natural reaction to its vacuum packing. USDA recommends cooking chicken to 165°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Season chicken

Bring a medium pot of water to a boil over high heat. Pat **chicken** very dry with paper towel (this will help the skin crisp up in the pan) and season all over with **half of dried oregano**, **½ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired.



2. Cook chicken

Heat **2 teaspoons olive oil** in a medium pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **chicken** skin-side down and sear until skin is golden and easily lifts from pan, 6 minutes. Flip and sear until cooked through and no longer pink, about 6 minutes more. Transfer **chicken** to a plate and set aside to rest; reserve fat in pan, off heat, for Step 5.



3. Cook penne

While chicken cooks, season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **penne** and cook until al dente, about 8 minutes. Drain and rinse under cold water for 30 seconds to stop cooking. Return to pot, off heat.



4. Prepare ingredients

While penne cooks, rinse all produce. Halve **cherry tomatoes**. Thinly slice **mini peppers** crosswise, discarding seeds and stems. Halve **cucumber** lengthwise, then thinly slice crosswise on a diagonal (see recipe tip). Roughly chop **olives**.



5. Make oregano vinaigrette

To pan from chicken, still off heat, add **red wine vinegar**, **sugar**, **remaining dried oregano**, **¼ teaspoon salt**, and **black pepper** as desired. Whisking continuously, slowly add **3 tablespoons olive oil**, scraping up browned bits from pan, until fully combined. Add **vinaigrette** to pot with penne, still off heat, along with **cherry tomatoes**, **mini peppers**, **cucumber**, **olives**, and **half of feta**. Toss to coat.



6. Plate Mediterranean chicken pasta salad

Cut rested **chicken** into ¼-inch slices. Divide **Mediterranean pasta salad** between shallow serving bowls, top with **sliced chicken**, and garnish with **remaining feta** (see recipe tip). Enjoy!

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